

ANNEXE: The Security Dilemma Dialogue — A Practical Guide

This annexe provides the practical basis for the co-counselling / perspective-taking proposal referenced in all letters above. It is drawn from established conflict transformation methodology and adapted for diplomatic contexts.

What is a Security Dilemma Dialogue?

A Security Dilemma Dialogue is a structured exercise in which participants — individually or as a team — spend time rigorously articulating the legitimate security fears of a nation they are currently in tension with. The goal is not to agree, concede, or negotiate. It is to demonstrate accurate understanding of why the other party feels existentially threatened. Misunderstanding of adversary fears is the single most consistent driver of nuclear miscalculation.

The Format (90-Minute Session)

1. Briefing (15 min): Participants are given a one-page summary of their assigned adversary's documented security concerns (open-source only).
2. Articulation (30 min): Participants argue the adversary's security case — in first person, as if they ARE that adversary — to their colleagues. No rebuttals.
3. Reflection (20 min): Facilitator asks: 'What did you hear that you hadn't fully considered?' Responses are noted, not judged.
4. Response (15 min): The group articulates, briefly, what their own state's core security fears are — often clarifying them for the first time.
5. Statement (10 min): Participants draft a one-sentence acknowledgment: 'We understand that [Adversary] fears [X]. Our own core fear is [Y]. These fears do not require military escalation to address.'

Safe Pilot Pairs — Recommended Starting Points

Pair	Existing Foundation	Risk Level
Vietnam + Japan	Historical reconciliation process; ASEAN ties	LOW — recommended first
Norway + Russia	Arctic Council cooperation; maritime law	LOW-MEDIUM
Australia + China	Trade restoration (2025-26); diplomatic re-engagement	MEDIUM
UAE + Iran	Hormuz opening; quiet Channel diplomacy	MEDIUM
South Korea + Japan	Recent normalization (2024); shared US alliance	MEDIUM
India + Pakistan	Pugwash track record; Eminent Persons precedent	MEDIUM-HIGH
US + China	Hormuz agreement (May 14); economic interdependence	HIGH — but highest reward

Source methodology: Co-Re (Re-evaluation Counselling); Nonviolent Communication (Marshall Rosenberg); Conflict Transformation (John Paul Lederach, Eastern Mennonite University); Security Dilemma theory (Robert Jervis, Columbia University).

Key References

NPT RevCon Official Site: [UNODA NPT RevCon 2026](#)

Arms Control Association Updates: [ACA NPT 2026 Blog](#)

Reaching Critical Will: [NPT 2026 Resources](#)

China Working Paper (Japan/plutonium): [WP.60 — China Elements to Outcome](#)

Global Stewardship Charter (CC0): [github.com/GlobalStewardship2026](#)

ICAN (Nobel Peace Prize, disarmament advocacy): [icanw.org](#)

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